

Weekly Shopping Lists

Each list covers every recipe cooked that week for two people, including the batches that feed the following days and the freezer; leftovers are not listed twice. Cross off what is already in the cupboard. **Every week, as well:** four litres of milk for the tea, coffee and porridge (it is a real share of the iodine); a bag of frozen berries; lemons; fruit for the daily piece (a dozen); a spare tub of low-fat Greek yogurt; and a jar of Brazil nuts that will last two months at one a day. Amounts are rounded up to what you can actually buy; the leftover half of a can or a pepper goes into the next day's salad or soup.

Shopping List - Week 1 - The Routine and the Iodine

Beans, grains and cans

- ☐ baking powder: 2 tsp
- ☐ chopped tomatoes (400 g): 1 can
- ☐ canned salmon, drained: 1 can
- ☐ tuna in spring water, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ cannellini beans, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ chickpeas, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ passata: 200 ml
- ☐ plain flour: 5 tbsp
- ☐ dried red lentils: 200 g
- ☐ reduced-salt chicken stock: 300 ml
- ☐ reduced-salt vegetable stock: 1000 ml
- ☐ rolled oats: 420 g
- ☐ sardines in tomato sauce: 2 cans
- ☐ white rice: 100 g
- ☐ wholegrain rice cakes: 2 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal flour: 100 g
- ☐ wholewheat pasta: 300 g

Fish and meat

- ☐ skinless chicken breast: 4 breasts
- ☐ skinless boneless chicken thighs: 4 thighs
- ☐ chicken, roast, skinless: 200 g
- ☐ cod fillet: 2 fillets
- ☐ haddock fillet: 4 fillets
- ☐ sirloin steak, lean: 1 steak
- ☐ lean turkey mince: 500 g
- ☐ white fish fillet: 3 fillets

Dairy, eggs and chilled

- ☐ low-fat cottage cheese: 2 pots
- ☐ egg: 18

- ☐ greek yogurt, low-fat: 4 pots
- ☐ low-fat natural yogurt: 2 pots
- ☐ parmesan: 4 tsp
- ☐ reduced-fat cheddar: 6 tbsp
- ☐ semi-skimmed milk: 3700 ml
- ☐ unsalted butter: 1 tbsp

Bread

- ☐ oatcakes: 6 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal bread: 24 slices
- ☐ wholewheat tortilla: 2 pieces

Nuts, seeds and oils

- ☐ almonds: 60 g
- ☐ ground flaxseed: 6 tsp
- ☐ olive oil: 200 ml
- ☐ peanut butter (no added sugar or salt): 100 g
- ☐ pumpkin seeds: 3 tbsp
- ☐ sunflower seeds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ tahini: 2 tbsp
- ☐ walnuts: 3 tbsp

Fruit and vegetables

- ☐ apple: 6
- ☐ avocado: 1
- ☐ banana: 4
- ☐ pepper: 1
- ☐ blueberries: 80 g
- ☐ broccoli: 450 g
- ☐ cabbage: 180 g
- ☐ carrot: 9
- ☐ cherry tomatoes: 3 punnets
- ☐ chives: 2 tbsp
- ☐ cucumber: 1
- ☐ fresh herbs: 11 tbsp

- ☐ frozen peas: 400 g
- ☐ garlic: 12 cloves
- ☐ ginger: 1 thumb
- ☐ grapes: 32
- ☐ green beans: 160 g
- ☐ leek: 2
- ☐ lemon: 8
- ☐ lettuce or salad leaves: 1 bag
- ☐ onion: 2
- ☐ peach or nectarine: 2
- ☐ pear: 6
- ☐ potato: 23
- ☐ red onion: 2
- ☐ rocket: 2 bags
- ☐ spinach: 1 bag
- ☐ spring onion: 2 pieces
- ☐ sweet potato: 4
- ☐ tomato: 8
- ☐ watercress: 2 bags

Store cupboard

- ☐ balsamic vinegar: 1 tbsp
- ☐ cinnamon: 4 tsp
- ☐ dried apricots: 8 pieces
- ☐ dried herbs or spices: 9 tsp
- ☐ honey: 70 g
- ☐ iodised salt: 1 tsp
- ☐ lime juice: 2 tsp
- ☐ maple syrup: 2 tsp
- ☐ mustard: 2 tbsp
- ☐ orange juice: 150 g
- ☐ raisins: 2 tbsp
- ☐ sugar: 2 tbsp

☐ vanilla extract: 2 tsp

☐ vinegar: 1 tbsp

Shopping List - Week 2 - The Selenium, the Iron and the Rest

Beans, grains and cans

- ☐ black beans, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ brown rice: 480 g
- ☐ chopped tomatoes (400 g): 4 cans
- ☐ tuna in spring water, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ cannellini beans, drained and rinsed: 4 cans
- ☐ chickpeas, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ dried green or brown lentils: 200 g
- ☐ kidney beans, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ no-salt vegetable stock, made up: 1000 ml
- ☐ nori sheets: 1 sheet
- ☐ pearl barley: 100 g
- ☐ reduced-salt chicken stock: 1300 ml
- ☐ reduced-salt vegetable stock: 700 ml
- ☐ rolled oats: 240 g
- ☐ sweetcorn (no added salt), drained: 1 can
- ☐ tomato puree: 3 tbsp
- ☐ wholegrain rice cakes: 2 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal flour: 6 tbsp
- ☐ wholewheat couscous: 120 g
- ☐ wholewheat pasta: 80 g

Fish and meat

- ☐ skinless chicken breast: 4 breasts
- ☐ lean beef mince (5% fat): 250 g
- ☐ pork tenderloin: 180 g
- ☐ salmon fillet: 2 fillets
- ☐ smoked salmon: 2 slices

Dairy, eggs and chilled

- ☐ low-fat cottage cheese: 1 pot

- ☐ egg: 24
- ☐ greek yogurt, low-fat: 5 pots
- ☐ hummus: 90 g
- ☐ kefir, low-fat: 500 ml
- ☐ low-fat natural yogurt: 3 pots
- ☐ olive oil spread: 3 tsp
- ☐ parmesan: 4 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-fat cheddar: 6 tbsp
- ☐ ricotta, part-skim: 60 g
- ☐ semi-skimmed milk: 900 ml
- ☐ unsalted butter: 70 g

Bread

- ☐ oatcakes: 6 pieces
- ☐ sourdough bread: 2 slices
- ☐ wholemeal bread: 14 slices
- ☐ wholemeal pitta: 2 pieces

Nuts, seeds and oils

- ☐ almonds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ brazil nuts: 2
- ☐ cashews: 2 tbsp
- ☐ ground almonds: 3 tbsp
- ☐ ground flaxseed: 6 tsp
- ☐ olive oil: 150 ml
- ☐ peanut butter (no added sugar or salt): 2 tbsp
- ☐ pumpkin seeds: 5 tbsp
- ☐ rapeseed oil: 13 ml
- ☐ sesame seeds: 2 tsp
- ☐ sunflower seeds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ tahini: 2 tbsp

Fruit and vegetables

- ☐ apple: 9
- ☐ banana: 4

- ☐ pepper: 2
- ☐ berries, fresh or frozen: 100 g
- ☐ broccoli: 150 g
- ☐ cabbage: 180 g
- ☐ carrot: 8
- ☐ celery: 240 g
- ☐ cherry tomatoes: 3 punnets
- ☐ chives: 4 tbsp
- ☐ courgette: 1
- ☐ cucumber: 1
- ☐ fresh herbs: 12 tbsp
- ☐ garlic: 15 cloves
- ☐ ginger: 4 thumbs
- ☐ grapes: 32
- ☐ leek: 1
- ☐ lemon: 2
- ☐ lettuce or salad leaves: 1 bag
- ☐ lime: 1
- ☐ mushrooms: 280 g
- ☐ onion: 7
- ☐ orange: 2
- ☐ pear: 6
- ☐ potato: 10
- ☐ spinach: 2 bags
- ☐ spring onion: 8 pieces
- ☐ tomato: 4

Store cupboard

- ☐ balsamic vinegar: 1 tbsp
- ☐ cinnamon: 1 tsp
- ☐ dried apricots: 8 pieces
- ☐ dried herbs or spices: 9 tsp
- ☐ honey: 80 g

- ☐ iodised salt: 1 tsp
- ☐ lemon juice: 3 tbsp
- ☐ maple syrup: 1 tsp
- ☐ mustard: 1 tsp
- ☐ peppers, roasted, jarred, drained: 2
- ☐ raisins: 2 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-salt soy sauce: 1 tbsp
- ☐ sugar: 2 tbsp
- ☐ vinegar: 1 tbsp

Shopping List - Week 3 - The Full Pattern

Beans, grains and cans

- ☐ baking powder: 3 tsp
- ☐ brown rice: 360 g
- ☐ butter beans, drained and rinsed: 2 cans
- ☐ chopped tomatoes (400 g): 2 cans
- ☐ canned salmon, drained: 1 can
- ☐ tuna in spring water, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ cannellini beans, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ chickpeas, drained and rinsed: 4 cans
- ☐ cornflour: 3 tsp
- ☐ no-salt vegetable stock, made up: 1000 ml
- ☐ pearl barley: 250 g
- ☐ reduced-salt chicken stock: 200 ml
- ☐ reduced-salt vegetable stock: 1600 ml
- ☐ rice noodles: 120 g
- ☐ rolled oats: 410 g
- ☐ wholegrain rice cakes: 2 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal flour: 300 g

Fish and meat

- ☐ skinless chicken breast: 3 breasts
- ☐ mackerel fillet: 2 fillets
- ☐ prawns, cooked: 200 g

Dairy, eggs and chilled

- ☐ butternut squash: 1
- ☐ low-fat cottage cheese: 3 pots
- ☐ egg: 10
- ☐ firm tofu: 1 block
- ☐ greek yogurt, low-fat: 10 pots
- ☐ kefir, low-fat: 500 ml
- ☐ low-fat natural yogurt: 1 pot

- ☐ parmesan: 6 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-fat cheddar: 70 g
- ☐ semi-skimmed milk: 2100 ml
- ☐ unsalted butter: 80 g

Bread

- ☐ oatcakes: 6 pieces
- ☐ wholemeal bread: 12 slices

Nuts, seeds and oils

- ☐ almonds: 60 g
- ☐ brazil nuts: 4
- ☐ chia seeds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ ground flaxseed: 4 tbsp
- ☐ olive oil: 150 ml
- ☐ peanut butter (no added sugar or salt): 2 tbsp
- ☐ pumpkin seeds: 60 g
- ☐ rapeseed oil: 40 ml
- ☐ sesame seeds: 1 tsp
- ☐ sunflower seeds: 5 tbsp
- ☐ tahini: 2 tbsp

Fruit and vegetables

- ☐ apple: 4
- ☐ banana: 6
- ☐ cooked beetroot: 2
- ☐ pepper: 2
- ☐ berries, fresh or frozen: 300 g
- ☐ blueberries: 80 g
- ☐ carrot: 6
- ☐ celery: 80 g
- ☐ cherry tomatoes: 2 punnets
- ☐ chilli: 1
- ☐ chives: 3 tbsp
- ☐ cucumber: 1

- ☐ fresh herbs: 7 tbsp
- ☐ frozen peas: 270 g
- ☐ garlic: 14 cloves
- ☐ ginger: 3 thumbs
- ☐ grapes: 32
- ☐ green beans: 480 g
- ☐ leek: 1
- ☐ lemon: 4
- ☐ lime: 2
- ☐ mango: 1
- ☐ mushrooms: 280 g
- ☐ onion: 5
- ☐ peach or nectarine: 2
- ☐ potato: 8
- ☐ red onion: 1
- ☐ rocket: 1 bag
- ☐ spinach: 2 bags
- ☐ spring onion: 2 pieces
- ☐ tomato: 4
- ☐ watercress: 1 bag

Store cupboard

- ☐ cinnamon: 3 tsp
- ☐ curry powder: 6 tsp
- ☐ dried apricots: 8 pieces
- ☐ dried herbs or spices: 4 tsp
- ☐ honey: 80 g
- ☐ iodised salt: 1 tsp
- ☐ maple syrup: 1 tbsp
- ☐ mustard: 2 tsp
- ☐ raisins: 80 g
- ☐ reduced-salt soy sauce: 1 tbsp
- ☐ sugar: 4 tbsp

☐ vanilla extract: 2 tsp

☐ vinegar: 1 tbsp

Shopping List - Week 4 - Make It Yours

Beans, grains and cans

- ☐ baking powder: 1 tsp
- ☐ chopped tomatoes (400 g): 1 can
- ☐ tuna in spring water, drained: 2 cans
- ☐ cannellini beans, drained and rinsed: 3 cans
- ☐ chickpeas, drained and rinsed: 1 can
- ☐ pearl barley: 100 g
- ☐ plain flour: 1 tbsp
- ☐ reduced-salt chicken stock: 1500 ml
- ☐ rolled oats: 390 g
- ☐ sardines in tomato sauce: 2 cans
- ☐ sweetcorn (no added salt), drained: 1 can
- ☐ tomato puree: 1 tbsp
- ☐ white rice: 100 g
- ☐ wholegrain rice cakes: 2 pieces

Fish and meat

- ☐ skinless chicken breast: 6 breasts
- ☐ skinless boneless chicken thighs: 4 thighs
- ☐ chicken, roast, skinless: 200 g
- ☐ cod fillet: 2 fillets
- ☐ sea bass fillet: 2 fillets
- ☐ sirloin steak, lean: 1 steak
- ☐ smoked salmon: 2 slices

Dairy, eggs and chilled

- ☐ low-fat cottage cheese: 1 pot
- ☐ egg: 19
- ☐ greek yogurt, low-fat: 10 pots
- ☐ hummus: 90 g
- ☐ kefir, low-fat: 500 ml
- ☐ low-fat natural yogurt: 2 pots

- ☐ reduced-fat cheddar: 4 tbsp
- ☐ semi-skimmed milk: 2650 ml
- ☐ unsalted butter: 1 tbsp

Bread

- ☐ oatcakes: 6 pieces
- ☐ sourdough bread: 2 slices
- ☐ wholemeal bread: 24 slices
- ☐ wholemeal pitta: 2 pieces
- ☐ wholewheat tortilla: 2 pieces

Nuts, seeds and oils

- ☐ almonds: 4 tbsp
- ☐ brazil nuts: 4
- ☐ ground flaxseed: 6 tsp
- ☐ olive oil: 150 ml
- ☐ peanut butter (no added sugar or salt): 100 g
- ☐ pumpkin seeds: 5 tbsp
- ☐ sunflower seeds: 5 tbsp
- ☐ tahini: 2 tbsp
- ☐ walnuts: 3 tbsp

Fruit and vegetables

- ☐ apple: 6
- ☐ avocado: 1
- ☐ banana: 8
- ☐ pepper: 1
- ☐ berries, fresh or frozen: 300 g
- ☐ broccoli: 450 g
- ☐ cabbage: 180 g
- ☐ carrot: 8
- ☐ celery: 80 g
- ☐ cherry tomatoes: 3 punnets
- ☐ chives: 6 tbsp
- ☐ cucumber: 1

- ☐ fennel bulb: 1
- ☐ fresh herbs: 8 tbsp
- ☐ garlic: 14 cloves
- ☐ ginger: 1 thumb
- ☐ grapes: 32
- ☐ leek: 1
- ☐ lemon: 6
- ☐ lettuce or salad leaves: 1 bag
- ☐ onion: 2
- ☐ orange: 2
- ☐ pear: 6
- ☐ potato: 12
- ☐ red onion: 1
- ☐ rocket: 1 bag
- ☐ spinach: 1 bag
- ☐ spring onion: 2 pieces
- ☐ sweet potato: 4
- ☐ tomato: 8
- ☐ watercress: 2 bags

Store cupboard

- ☐ balsamic vinegar: 1 tbsp
- ☐ cinnamon: 2 tsp
- ☐ dark chocolate (70%): 4 tbsp
- ☐ dried apricots: 8 pieces
- ☐ dried herbs or spices: 8 tsp
- ☐ honey: 100 g
- ☐ iodised salt: 1 tsp
- ☐ lemon juice: 3 tbsp
- ☐ lime juice: 2 tsp
- ☐ maple syrup: 1 tsp
- ☐ mustard: 1 tbsp
- ☐ orange juice: 150 g

- ☐ peppers, roasted, jarred, drained: 2
- ☐ sugar: 2 tbsp
- ☐ vanilla extract: 2 tsp
- ☐ vinegar: 1 tsp

28-Day Meal Planner

Pin this to the fridge. Codes point to the recipe chapter; * means leftovers or a freezer portion. Tick the pill box when the levothyroxine has gone down on an empty stomach, and the day box when it is done.

Week 1 - The Routine and the Iodine

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Pill	Done
1	Porridge Made with Milk, Banana and Sunflower Seeds (B1)	Lentil, Carrot and Cumin Soup (for four) (L1)	Baked Cod with a Lemon and Herb Crust, New Potatoes and Broccoli (D1)	Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1)	☐	☐
2	Two-Egg Omelette with Spinach, Tomato and Cheddar (B3)	Egg, Watercress and Tomato Sandwich (L4)	Paprika Chicken Traybake with Sweet Potato, Peppers and Broccoli (D8)	A Boiled Egg with Cherry Tomatoes and a Rice Cake (S5); Poached Pears in Orange and Cinnamon (for four) (P6)	☐	☐
3	Cottage Cheese, Peach and Toasted Almond Bowl (B9)	Lentil, Carrot and Cumin Soup (for four) (L1*)	Haddock, Leek and Pea Fish Pie (for four) (D2)	Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1)	☐	☐
4	Wholemeal Toast with Peanut Butter, Banana and a Glass of Milk (B5)	Chicken, Avocado and Salad Wrap (L7)	Peppered Sirloin with Sweet Potato Wedges and Watercress (for two) (D13)	Home-Made Hummus with Carrot and Cucumber Sticks (for four) (S3); Poached Pears in Orange and Cinnamon (for four) (P6*)	☐	☐
5	Overnight Oats with Apple, Raisins and Flaxseed (B4)	Sardines on Toast with Tomato and Lemon (L8)	Turkey Meatballs in Tomato Sauce with Wholewheat Spaghetti (for four) (D9)	Cheese and Oatcakes with Grapes (S4)	☐	☐
6	Pancakes with Blueberries and Yogurt (for two) (B11)	Tuna, Cannellini Bean and Red Onion Salad (L2)	Fish Cakes with Peas and Lemon (for four) (D6)	Home-Made Hummus with Carrot and Cucumber Sticks (for four)	☐	☐

				(S3*); A Boiled Egg with Cherry Tomatoes and a Rice Cake (S5); Rice Pudding Made with Milk and Nutmeg (for four) (P2)		
7	Baked Oats with Pear, Ginger and Egg (for four) (B7)	Salmon, New Potato and Green Bean Salad (for two) (L5)	Sunday Roast Chicken with Roast Vegetables and Real Gravy (for four) (D10)	Trail Mix: Almonds, Pumpkin Seeds and Dried Apricots (for four) (S6); Rice Pudding Made with Milk and Nutmeg (for four) (P2*)	☐	☐

Week 2 - The Selenium, the Iron and the Rest

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Pill	Done
8	Banana, Oat and Yogurt Smoothie (B6)	Chicken, Barley and Vegetable Soup (for four) (L3)	Salmon with Herb Couscous and Roasted Tomatoes (D3)	Greek Yogurt with Honey and One Brazil Nut (S2)	☐	☐
9	Baked Oats with Pear, Ginger and Egg (for four) (B7*)	Hummus, Roast Pepper and Egg Pitta (L9)	Beef and Bean Chilli with Brown Rice (for four) (D15)	A Boiled Egg with Cherry Tomatoes and a Rice Cake (S5); Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1); Baked Apples with Oats, Raisins and Yogurt (for four) (P1)	☐	☐
10	Baked Beans from Scratch on Toast (for four) (B12)	Chicken, Barley and Vegetable Soup (for four) (L3*)	Chicken, Cashew and Broccoli Stir-Fry (D12)	Cottage Cheese on Toast with Tomato and Chives (S7)	☐	☐
11	Bircher Muesli with Grated Apple, Yogurt and Seeds (B10)	Tuna, Sweetcorn and Yogurt Jacket Potato (L11)	Lentil and Mushroom Shepherd's Pie (for four) (D18)	Trail Mix: Almonds, Pumpkin Seeds and Dried Apricots (for four) (S6); Kefir or Milk with a Banana (S8); Baked Apples	☐	☐

				with Oats, Raisins and Yogurt (for four) (P1*)		
12	Baked Beans from Scratch on Toast (for four) (B12*)	Mushroom, Egg and Nori Rice Bowl (L12)	Pork Tenderloin with Apple and Braised Cabbage (for two) (D14)	Greek Yogurt with Honey and One Brazil Nut (S2)	☐	☐
13	Two-Egg Omelette with Spinach, Tomato and Cheddar (B3)	Beef and Bean Chilli with Brown Rice (for four) (D15*)	Haddock, Leek and Pea Fish Pie (for four) (D2*)	Cheese and Oatcakes with Grapes (S4); Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1); Pear and Ginger Oat Crumble (for six) (P4)	☐	☐
14	Scrambled Eggs with Smoked Salmon on Sourdough (B8)	Minestrone with Beans and Wholewheat Pasta (for four) (L6)	Spinach, Ricotta and Egg Frittata with Salad (for two) (D20)	Home-Made Hummus with Carrot and Cucumber Sticks (for four) (S3); Pear and Ginger Oat Crumble (for six) (P4*)	☐	☐

Week 3 - The Full Pattern

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Pill	Done
15	Porridge Made with Milk, Banana and Sunflower Seeds (B1)	Spinach, Ricotta and Egg Frittata with Salad (for two) (D20*)	Prawn, Ginger and Vegetable Stir-Fry with Rice Noodles (D4)	A Boiled Egg with Cherry Tomatoes and a Rice Cake (S5)	☐	☐
16	Cottage Cheese, Peach and Toasted Almond Bowl (B9)	Minestrone with Beans and Wholewheat Pasta (for four) (L6*)	Chicken and Chickpea Curry with Spinach and Yogurt (for four) (D11)	Greek Yogurt with Honey and One Brazil Nut (S2); Chia Pudding with Mango (for two) (P3)	☐	☐
17	Overnight Oats with Apple, Raisins and Flaxseed (B4)	Roasted Butternut and Chickpea Soup (for four) (L10)	Grilled Mackerel with Beetroot, Potato and Horseradish Yogurt (D5)	Cottage Cheese on Toast with Tomato and Chives (S7); Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1);	☐	☐

				Chia Pudding with Mango (for two) (P3*)		
18	Greek Yogurt with Berries, Oats and One Brazil Nut (B2)	Chicken and Chickpea Curry with Spinach and Yogurt (for four) (D11*)	Tofu, Ginger and Vegetable Stir-Fry with Brown Rice (D17)	Trail Mix: Almonds, Pumpkin Seeds and Dried Apricots (for four) (S6)	☐	☐
19	Banana, Oat and Yogurt Smoothie (B6)	Roasted Butternut and Chickpea Soup (for four) (L10*)	Fish Cakes with Peas and Lemon (for four) (D6*)	Cheese and Oatcakes with Grapes (S4); Yogurt, Berry and Granola Parfait (P7)	☐	☐
20	Pancakes with Blueberries and Yogurt (for two) (B11)	Tuna, Cannellini Bean and Red Onion Salad (L2)	White Bean and Vegetable Stew with Cheddar Dumplings (for four) (D16)	Kefir or Milk with a Banana (S8); Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1); Oat and Raisin Cookies (makes twelve, two a serving) (P8)	☐	☐
21	Two-Egg Omelette with Spinach, Tomato and Cheddar (B3)	Salmon, New Potato and Green Bean Salad (for two) (L5)	Mushroom and Barley Risotto with Parmesan (for four) (D19)	Home-Made Hummus with Carrot and Cucumber Sticks (for four) (S3); Oat and Raisin Cookies (makes twelve, two a serving) (P8*)	☐	☐

Week 4 - Make It Yours

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Pill	Done
22	Wholemeal Toast with Peanut Butter, Banana and a Glass of Milk (B5)	Egg, Watercress and Tomato Sandwich (L4)	Baked Cod with a Lemon and Herb Crust, New Potatoes and Broccoli (D1)	Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1)	☐	☐
23	Bircher Muesli with Grated Apple, Yogurt and Seeds (B10)	Mushroom and Barley Risotto with Parmesan (for four) (D19*)	Paprika Chicken Traybake with Sweet Potato, Peppers and Broccoli (D8)	A Boiled Egg with Cherry Tomatoes and a Rice Cake (S5); Apple Slices with Peanut Butter	☐	☐

				(S1); Dark Chocolate and Banana on Toast (P5)		
24	Baked Beans from Scratch on Toast (for four) (B12)	Chicken, Avocado and Salad Wrap (L7)	Lentil and Mushroom Shepherd's Pie (for four) (D18*)	Cottage Cheese on Toast with Tomato and Chives (S7)	☐	☐
25	Greek Yogurt with Berries, Oats and One Brazil Nut (B2)	Sardines on Toast with Tomato and Lemon (L8)	Eat out (Ch. 12)	Trail Mix: Almonds, Pumpkin Seeds and Dried Apricots (for four) (S6)	☐	☐
26	Banana, Oat and Yogurt Smoothie (B6)	Hummus, Roast Pepper and Egg Pitta (L9)	Sea Bass with Fennel, Tomatoes and White Beans (D7)	Cheese and Oatcakes with Grapes (S4); Kefir or Milk with a Banana (S8); Yogurt, Berry and Granola Parfait (P7)	☐	☐
27	Scrambled Eggs with Smoked Salmon on Sourdough (B8)	Tuna, Sweetcorn and Yogurt Jacket Potato (L11)	Peppered Sirloin with Sweet Potato Wedges and Watercress (for two) (D13)	Home-Made Hummus with Carrot and Cucumber Sticks (for four) (S3); Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1); Poached Pears in Orange and Cinnamon (for four) (P6)	☐	☐
28	Baked Oats with Pear, Ginger and Egg (for four) (B7)	Chicken, Barley and Vegetable Soup (for four) (L3)	Sunday Roast Chicken with Roast Vegetables and Real Gravy (for four) (D10)	Greek Yogurt with Honey and One Brazil Nut (S2); Apple Slices with Peanut Butter (S1); Rice Pudding Made with Milk and Nutmeg (for four) (P2)	☐	☐

My Own Week

Write your own week from the recipes you liked. The rules: milk, yogurt or eggs at breakfast; white fish twice a week and oily fish once; one Brazil nut a day and no more; protein at every meal; fruit or vegetables at every meal; red meat once or twice; the pill on waking with water and nothing else for half an hour; calcium, iron and antacids four hours away. Aim for 150 to 300 micrograms of iodine and 70 to 200 of selenium a day from food.

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Pill	Done
Mon					☐	☐
Tue					☐	☐
Wed					☐	☐
Thu					☐	☐
Fri					☐	☐
Sat					☐	☐
Sun					☐	☐

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks / dessert	Pill	Done
Mon					☐	☐
Tue					☐	☐
Wed					☐	☐
Thu					☐	☐
Fri					☐	☐
Sat					☐	☐
Sun					☐	☐

Symptom, Pill and Test Tracker

My levothyroxine dose: _____ mcg, brand _____. Taken at: _____ (empty stomach; nothing but water for 30 to 60 minutes). Other medicines and supplements, with their times: _____ . My next blood test: _____

The symptom score

Score each 0 (none), 1 (mild), 2 (moderate) or 3 (severe), and add them up. Do it before you start, at four weeks, and before each blood test; the total is what to show the doctor, and a total that does not fall when the TSH is normal is the cue for the other tests in Chapter 8 (ferritin, B12, vitamin D) and the other causes (sleep, mood, the menopause).

Symptom	Start	Week 4	Week 8	Week 12	Next test
Tiredness					
Feeling the cold					
Constipation					
Dry skin or hair loss					
Weight going up					
Low mood					
Slow thinking or memory					
Aches and stiffness					
Puffy face or eyes					
Heavy or irregular periods (if any)					
Hoarse voice					
TOTAL					

The tests

Date	TSH	Free T4	TPO antibodies	Ferritin	B12	Vitamin D	Cholesterol	Dose changed to	Notes
Start									
6-8 weeks after any dose change									
3 months									
6 months									
1 year									

The habits, week by week

Tick each day you managed all five: the pill on an empty stomach at the usual time; calcium, iron and antacids four hours away; milk, yogurt or eggs at breakfast; fish, and the one Brazil nut, on their days; the walk.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Week 1							
Week 2							
Week 3							
Week 4							
Week 5							
Week 6							
Week 7							
Week 8							

Week 9							
Week 10							
Week 11							
Week 12							

This week: walks _____ weight _____ bowels (days opened) _____ hours slept (average)
 _____ pill missed _____ days

The Fridge Card: The Pill Rules, and Keep, Limit, Avoid

Cut out and keep on the fridge. Targets from food: 150 to 300 micrograms of iodine a day, 70 to 200 of selenium; protein at every meal; no supplement unless a blood test says so.

The six pill rules. 1. Levothyroxine on waking, with a glass of water, on an empty stomach. 2. Nothing else for 30 minutes, 60 if you can: no breakfast, no coffee, no milk. 3. Calcium, iron, antacids (aluminium or magnesium) and multivitamins with minerals: four hours away. 4. Same time, same brand, every day; a missed dose is taken the same day when you remember, or two the next day, never skipped for good. 5. Blood test six to eight weeks after any change of dose or brand, then once a year, first thing, before the pill. 6. Stop any biotin supplement (hair, skin and nails tablets) three days before a thyroid blood test; it makes the result wrong.

Keep (every day)	Limit	Avoid
Milk, yogurt, kefir and a little cheese: the reliable iodine	Brazil nuts: one a day, two at most	Kelp, kombu, bladderwrack, 'sea moss', seaweed supplements and iodine drops: more iodine in a capsule than in a week of food, and the thing most likely to make a Hashimoto's thyroid worse
Eggs, most days	Soy (tofu, edamame, soya milk): fine at lunch or dinner, four hours from the pill	'Thyroid support' supplements: some contain real thyroid hormone, and none has evidence
White fish (cod, haddock, pollock, hake) twice a week: the richest iodine there is	Fresh tuna steak, swordfish, marlin: once a week or less (mercury); canned tuna is fine	Iodine, selenium or zinc tablets without a blood test and a doctor who has seen it
Oily fish (salmon, mackerel, sardines) once a week: selenium, vitamin D, omega-3	Raw cruciferous vegetables (raw kale smoothies, coleslaw by the bowl): fine in ordinary amounts; cooked, they are simply vegetables	Coffee, grapefruit juice or a high-fibre breakfast inside the hour after the pill
Wholegrains, seeds, beans, lentils: selenium, zinc, iron and the fibre	Red meat: once or twice a week, about 100 g, for the iron	A gluten-free diet without a coeliac test first (the test needs you to be eating gluten)
Fruit and vegetables at every meal, the cruciferous ones cooked	Alcohol: within the limits in Chapter 6	Crash diets and very-low-calorie plans: they lower the active thyroid hormone further

Water through the day; the walk; the sleep	Plant milks: check the label for added iodine; most have none	Skipping the pill on the days you feel well
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My two columns. Morning, on waking, with water and nothing else: _____.
Evening, with food, four hours away: _____.

Call the doctor for a fast or pounding heartbeat, sweating, shaking, anxiety, weight falling without trying or diarrhoea (the dose may now be too high); for a lump in the neck, trouble swallowing or a change in the voice; for symptoms that have not improved three months after the TSH came right; or, as an emergency, for confusion, extreme drowsiness or a body that is very cold and slow (myxoedema; rare, and a 911 / 999 call).

From The Thyroid Diet Plan for Women Over 50 by Eleanor Whitfield. oroenigma.com/thyroid